



FILM REVIEWS

ALL THE BEST

Proud to be Loud

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

Director: Rohit Shetty**Starring:** Ajay Devgan, Fardeen Khan, Bipasha Basu, Mughda Godse

There are jokes about Africans, who are shown as men with boot polish on their faces; about the

speech-impaired; and of men who like to sleep with men. Welcome to the inglorious world of Rohit Shetty, creator of the *Golmaal* series, where no joke is too low brow, too poor or too politically incorrect. Where grown men leap about onscreen slapping other grown men, and where all the women wear provocative minis while doing mundane domestic tasks. The plot involves Sanjay Dutt who is on his way to Lesotho and

lands up in Goa to look up his brother Fardeen Khan who is spending his pocket money (Rs 1 lakh a month) mostly on his best friend Ajay Devgan. But the stars of the crazy circus are the no-marquee actors. There's Sanjay Mishra, who plays RGV, or Raghu-nandandas Govardhandas Vakawle, and says things like, "I don't want rental with this mental, he will break my dental", and the underrated Ashwini Kalsekar as a Malayali *ayah* named Mary, whose theme song is *Baharon phool barsao, mera mehboob AYAH hai*. "First there was T-Series, now there will be Coffee series." "I don't care a Bhakra Nangal dam." Yes, it's that sort of a film where the lines seem to have been ad-libbed on the sets while the actors were in a holiday mood. The movie is designed in primary colours, with emotions to match. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

BLUE

All at Sea

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

Director: Anthony D' Souza**Starring:** Sanjay Dutt, Akshay Kumar, Zayed Khan and Lara Dutta's bikini

You know you're watching a Bollywood action movie when the stars

bark bilingual orders, saying everything twice, in Hindi and English. But *Blue* is not about text or subtext. It is all about the string of string bikinis Lara Dutta sports, the underwater marine life as a bunch of boys search for sunken treasure and the curious case of Sanjay Dutt's paunch that seems to have a life of its own. Bikes, babes, boats, the Bahamas and Bangkok as well. There are lots of explosions, car chases and motorboat rides. There's Kylie Minogue's jiggy wiggly and A.R. Rahman's moody music. What is missing is a taut plot and yes, a confrontation with the sharks, who swim about lazily as if they're on National Geographic. There's also the hint of a sequel but given that one gets seasick even in a less-than-two-hour-long movie, I don't think so. If nothing else, it will add to Dutta's, ahem, body of work. **-KB**

MAIN AUR MRS KHANNA
Couple Trouble

RATING ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Prem Soni**Starring:** Salman Khan, Kareena Kapoor, Sohail Khan

Is this a romantic film with an element of comedy or a comedy film with an element of romance? Difficult to say when Salman Khan is in lecture mode, discussing the impact of financial stability on a marriage and recession on the job market. There's also a dissertation on how wine is good for the heart. Everyone is supposed to play middle class characters plagued by a lack of money, marital troubles and parental discord. But from Chanel top to Laboutin toe, Kareena looks the perfect ad for the high life. The saving grace? A bejewelled Bappi Lahiri singing Hindi songs in Bangla. **-KB**

